

A primer to Microsoft Game Stack

Microsoft's game development bid

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O

n 14th of March, Microsoft announced that they are going to launch a new cloud based platform for

Game Development, where they are going to provide various software development kits (SDKs) allowing cross-platform capabilities between Xbox Live and iOS and Android games. This also includes all of their gaming-related platforms like Azure, DirectX, Havok, Mixer, Xbox, Visual Studio, Power BI, UWP, Windows ML and many more. According to Kareem Choudhry, Corporate Vice President, Microsoft Gaming Cloud Platform, "We commit to bringing together Microsoft tools and services that will



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empower game developers like yourself, whether you're an indie developer just starting out or a AAA studio, to achieve more."

It is worth noting that in this platform a developer is free to choose from all of the tools that Microsoft has in their arsenal. With Azure being

their preferred choice for a cloud platform, the developer can easily switch between various components depending on the build.

SUPPORTED PLATFORMS

According to their website, Game Stack is primarily going to support these platforms: Xbox, PlayStation, Nintendo Switch, iOS, Android, Web, Cloud, Windows, Linux and Smart TV.

So what it actually translates to is that if a small gaming company is going to build a game for

Xbox using the Game-Stack then eventually with minimal effort they can transfer that game to the other ten platforms. This is a huge bonus where portability was a huge problem for any kind of software development, now companies can easily focus on the game development, and the platform can take care of the rest.

KEY COMPONENT

Microsoft recently acquired PlayFab and made it the core of its Game-Stack. PlayFab, as a core component of this

ecosystem, is a complete backend platform to build and operate live games. PlayFab is a mix of game services, data analytics and LiveOps, all in a unified solution. PlayFab comes with a host of features to work upon.

Here is a comprehensive list of all the features that PlayFab provides you as a platform:

Fast: Launch your games sooner and in a more cost effective manner than doing everything by yourself. PlayFab simplifies development with full access to all back-end services from day one. Also you can monitor and react to game data in real time.

Comprehensive: Everything that you need is there in one unified device agnostic solution. Microsoft is putting a lot of emphasis on making the platform device-agnostic so that you can work across all consoles (Xbox, Switch, PlayStation), PCs, and mobile devices (iOS and Android). Also, you can manage the entire gamer lifecycle of acquisition, engagement, and retention from an integrated command control center for your entire team.



Kareem Choudhry describing Game Stack



Everything you get